

HOW DECARBONISATION OF BUILT URBAN ENVIRONMENT CAN REDUCE AND CONTROL RISE IN GLOBAL TEMPERATURE

A mix of creativity, innovation and technology is a must to develop new-age buildings that can control / limit global warming.

The last few months of a brutal summer were a prelude to what is to come if global climate continues to degenerate. The US has been experiencing a severe heat wave and Mumbai, according to climate scientists, is drowning two inches every year due to rising water levels. Climate change migration has become a reality and shifting seasons has severely affected global farming practices.

But the good news is, we can still reduce and limit some of the damage caused by global warming. A report by the Energy Transitions Commission says that Carbon Dioxide Removals (CDR), alongside rapid and deep global decarbonisation, can increase our chances of limiting global warming by 1.5 degree Celsius, i.e. by 50 percent. While all sectors need to pitch in the mission, the real estate industry must lead the movement by implementing the right measures and practices to decarbonise the built environment, as buildings account for approximately 40 percent of total global energy use and emissions.

But how? There are a couple of big and small measures that can go a long way in saving the planet. What the real estate industry needs is innovation, creativity, technology and the willingness to do right by its communities.

New building regulations

Large cities amount for 75 percent of global emissions and have already started facing dire consequences. New building regulations can be a starting point in ensuring ecologically responsible construction.

Operations and Maintenance from the Green Business Certification Inc (GBCI). LEED v4.1 is the latest standard for green building design, construction, operations and performance.And Nucleus Office Parks, India's biggest office portfolio,have Leadership in Energy and Environmental Design (LEED) certifications for existing buildings v4.1:

Their much-talked about, 10,000-sq-ft garden with a community space, sitting arena, play and public area beneath the flyover in Lower Parel is part of the One Green Mile Project, developed by Nucleus Office Parks, in one of the first public-private-partnership (PPP) projects which envisaged redevelopment of a one-mile stretch on one of the busiest streets of Mumbai's central business district.

A push for cycling and electric cart tracks

In large residential and corporate properties, the users often use their cars to drive from one end to another.